

turned on from Quick Settings, and users can configure what is allowed during those modes. That makes DND ideal for sleep, work blocks, classes, recording sessions, interviews, prayer, driving, gaming, reading, writing or family time.

The mistake is using DND without exceptions. If you silence everything, you may miss an emergency. If you allow everything, DND is pointless. Build it like a gate, not a wall.



Step-by-step: configure Do Not Disturb properly

- Open Settings.
- Search for Do Not Disturb or Modes.
- Open Do Not Disturb.
- Set allowed people: starred contacts, family or selected contacts.
- Allow repeated callers if you want emergency calls to break through.
- Allow alarms.
- Decide whether calendar events and reminders should come through.
- Block media sounds, touch sounds and notification pop-ups if needed.
- Add DND to Quick Settings for fast access.
- Test it by asking a trusted contact to call or message.

This is particularly useful at night. Your phone can be quiet without making you unreachable to the few people who matter.

Bedtime Mode: sleep is a phone setting too

Android's Digital Wellbeing tools include Bedtime Mode, which can help reduce phone use at night. Google's Android support says users can set Bedtime Mode through Digital Wellbeing & parental controls, choose a schedule or have it turn on while charging during a chosen time window. The Digital Wellbeing Play Store listing describes Bedtime Mode as able to fade the screen to grayscale while DND silences notifications.

This is more powerful than it sounds. Grayscale makes the phone less visually rewarding. DND reduces interruptions. A schedule removes decision-making. At 11:30 pm, your willpower is not at its finest. Let the phone help.

Step-by-step: set up Bedtime Mode

- Open Settings.
- Tap Digital Wellbeing & parental controls.
- Tap Bedtime Mode.
- Choose Use a schedule or Turn on while charging.
- Set start and end times.
- Enable Do Not Disturb during bedtime.
- Enable grayscale if you want the phone to feel less tempting.
- Allow important contacts through DND.
- Try it for one week before adjusting.

The aim is not moral superiority. The aim is to stop your phone from turning one last check into another lost hour.

Focus Mode: pause the apps that hijack you

Focus Mode is one of Android's cleanest digital sanity tools. Google's Digital Wellbeing page says Focus Mode lets users select apps to pause temporarily, so distracting apps can be turned off when you need to get something done. The trick is to be honest. Do not add apps you rarely use.

Focus Mode does not need to be permanent. Use it in blocks: exam study, article writing, office work, editing, reading, meetings, workouts, family meals, or the first hour after waking up.

Step-by-step: create a work Focus Mode

- Open Settings.
- Tap Digital Wellbeing & parental controls.
- Tap Focus Mode.
- Select distracting apps.
- Set a schedule, such as weekdays from 10 am to 1 pm.
- Turn it on.
- Try opening a paused app to understand how the reminder works.
- Use Take a break only when genuinely needed.
- Review the app list every week.